

Week 9 - Taking the Alphabet profit and raising cash

Week ending 04 May 2026

Snapshot

Stock value	Around £1,780
Cash	Around £220
Total portfolio value	Around £2,000
Week 8 value	£2,008.07
Weekly change	About -£8 / -0.4%
Starting cost basis	About £1,999
Cash position	About 11% of the portfolio

A reset week

Week 9 was not exciting, but it was important. The portfolio was basically sitting around the £2,000 mark, made up of roughly £1,780 in stocks and £220 in cash. Compared with Week 8, the account was only down about £8, so the total value was not really the issue.

The bigger change was the structure of the account. I was no longer fully invested because I sold Alphabet and created a proper cash position. That made the portfolio feel more protected and gave me more room to think before putting money back into anything.

The Alphabet sale

The best thing this week was locking in the Alphabet gain. Alphabet had become one of the stronger positions in the portfolio, so selling it and taking about £40.63 profit was a decent result. It meant part of the recent recovery had actually been banked rather than just sitting as a paper gain.

At the same time, selling Alphabet also removed one of the cleaner quality names from the portfolio. I was happy with the profit, but I did not want to just throw the cash into

something weaker for the sake of being invested. The point of raising cash was to become more patient, not more random.

How the account felt afterwards

The account felt more careful than exciting. It was no longer chasing losses like it had been earlier, but it also had not built a big enough cushion to become comfortable. One bad week could still take the portfolio back below the starting value.

Symbotic remained one of the main names to watch. It had recovered well, but I did not want to treat that as proof the risk had disappeared. If earnings were strong, it could help a lot. If guidance disappointed, it could give back some of the recovery quickly.

The lesson

The main lesson was that cash can be an active position. Before this, everything had to keep working because the portfolio was basically fully deployed. Now I had some dry powder, and that gave me the ability to wait for a better entry rather than forcing a trade.